

Photographs by AP



ISI'S DEVIOUS PLANS

- Intelligence reports suggest ISI is likely to accelerate its anti-India terror operations. Indian missions in the neighbourhood are at risk.
- Arming Taliban fighters in Afghanistan to mount anti-India, -US and -ISAF operations to facilitate the return of their regime.
- Infiltration from across the LoC is on the rise and attacks are expected in the run-up to the J&K elections.
- ISI is trying to revive the Khalistan movement. Cadres are being trained to print fake currency and foment communal tension in India.

ernment. As the Kabul attack indicates, the agency has now prepared a lethal cocktail of terrorist groups like Taliban and Al Qaeda, which are fomenting trouble in Afghanistan to hit at Indian and NATO-US targets. They fear that stability in Afghanistan would turn the country, which has been used by ISI as a safe haven for running its terror training and drug-trafficking operations, away from their influence. On the other flank, ISI continues to aid terrorist groups like Lashkar-e-Toiba and Jaish-e-Mohammed from its camps in Pakistan-occupied Kashmir to mount anti-India terrorist operations.

Taliban, which was ousted from Afghanistan in 2001, was the offspring of ISI. Pakistan was one of the three



EPICENTRE:
Menon
(centre) with
Prasad (left)
in Kabul

TRUST

Increasingly the agency is running its anti-India operations through third countries. According to sources, intelligence agencies have recently pointed out that ISI has been trying to set up a TV station in Dhaka with the help of a local politician, which could be used to spread its anti-India activities.

"The ISI has set up an elaborate network of its retired officials to arm and train Taliban to carry out terrorist at-

tacks. The entire network led by Mullah Omar is being sheltered in ISI safehouses in Quetta. This, in turn, is being funded by the billions of dollars that the US is giving Pakistan to combat terrorism," says G. Parthasarthy, former high commissioner to Pakistan.

But the big question remains, why would Islamabad want to exacerbate tensions with India, when the Yusuf Gilani Government has just assumed power in Pakistan? The answer is that some elements in ISI and Pakistan Army want the strategy of bleeding India to continue and to demonstrate that they are still in control despite the conciliatory noises made by the new gov-

countries that maintained diplomatic relations with Taliban. India's reconstruction efforts there have now empowered the Afghan people thereby helping it gain goodwill. This is opposed both by ISI and Taliban.

The Kabul attack was a clear message by the Pakistani intelligence agency that it can hit at the core of India's strategic interests in Afghanistan and that more such attacks could follow on Indian targets to dissuade the country from undertaking reconstruction projects there. For ISI, which earned its bread and butter from fomenting terrorism, it will be difficult to change tack, unless there is a systematic overhaul of its policies under sustained international pressure. For India, the Kabul attack should transform into an opportunity to rally international support against terrorism in the region and to expose Pakistan's active role as an epicentre of terrorism. ■



"Kabul attacks were carried out by Pakistan's intelligence and military department."

HAMID KARZAI, AFGHANISTAN PRESIDENT